INCH-POUND
A-A-55284A
April 26, 2021
SUPERSEDING
A-A-55284
September 26, 1995

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BUCKLES, PLATED

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description as a replacement for MIL-B-17910D and MIL-B-20588F for all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE.

This commercial item description covers buckles intended for use with the men's coat belt or the military police belt.

2. CLASSIFICATION.

The buckles shall be of the following classes and types:

Class 1 - Solid polished brass (Marine Corps)
    Type I - Deleted
    Type II -Deleted
Class 2 - Die cast zinc and aluminum alloy with chrome-plated finish
Class 3 - Die cast zinc and aluminum alloy with brass-plated finish
Class 4- Gold Plated
    Type I
    Type II

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: DLA Troop Support, Clothing and Textiles Directorate, Attn: FQSE, 700 Robbins Ave, Philadelphia, PA 19111. Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

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AMSC N/A FSC 8315

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3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

3.1 Description.

The class 4, type I buckle shall be 1-3/16 x 2-5/32 x 3/32 inch (±1/64 inch), and the corners and edges shall be slightly beveled. The thickness of the outside vertical portions of the body shall be .250 (±.005) inch. The thickness of the outside horizontal portions of the body shall be .156 (±.005) inch. The thickness of the inside vertical bar shall be .187 (±.005) inch.

The class 4, type II buckle shall have outside dimensions of 2 x 2-5/16 x 1/8 inch (±1/16 inch) and shall be of stamped construction. The inside dimensions of the buckle shall be 1-1/2 x 1-13/16 x 1/8 inch (±1/16 inch). The center vertical bar shall be 1/4 inch thick, and the tongue wire shall be .144 (±.005) inch in diameter.

The class 2 and class 3 buckles shall have outside dimensions of 2-3/8 x 2-7/16 x 3/16 inch (± 1/16 inch) and shall be of die cast construction. The inside dimensions of the buckle shall be 1-3/4 x 1-13/16 x 3/16 inch (±1/16 inch). The center vertical bar shall be 7/32 inch thick, and the tongue wire shall be .144 (±.005) inch in diameter. Figures 1 and 2 are furnished for informational purposes only.

3.1 Materials

3.1.1 Class 4, type I and type II. The body of the type I and II buckles, and the tongue for Type II buckles shall be made from copper alloy number 260 or 268 (yellow brass), and the tongue for the type II buckle, made from copper alloy number 230 (red brass), shall conform to ASTM B36/B36M or ASTM B121/B121M requirements. A cut-out shall be provided in the center bar of the type II buckle to retain the tongue in position in the center of the bar. The top surfaces and outside edges of the buckle body shall be polished to a uniform, mirror-like finish. The back shall have a satin finish.

3.1.1.1 Gold for Plating. The class 4 type I and II buckle and the tongue for Type II shall be 24 karat gold.

3.1.1.1.1 Plating. All plating shall be by electroplating methods. The plating shall be continuous and unbroken over the entire plated surface. Plating of attaching devices will not be required.

3.1.2 Class 2 and class 3. The body of the class 2 and class 3 buckles shall be die cast from a zinc base alloy conforming to ASTM B86 requirements. Ribs shall be provided on the center bar to retain the tongue in the center of the bar. All surfaces of the class 2 buckle body shall be burnished to a smooth surface texture. The body shall then be copper plated followed by nickel plating and then by chrome plating. The top surfaces of the buckle body which are exposed to view when worn shall be polished to a uniform, mirror-like finish. The class 3 buckle body shall be prepared and plated in the same manner as the class 2 buckle; except, in lieu of chrome, the final plating shall be brass. After polishing, the body shall be coated with a clear, baked-on epoxy lacquer.

3.1.3 The tongue. The wire for the tongue shall be fabricated from copper alloy number 260 or 270 conforming to ASTM B134/B134M, ASTM B159/B159M, or ASTM B206/B206M requirements. When assembled to the buckle body, the tongue shall not bind on the center bar; the tip of the tongue shall not protrude beyond the outer edge of the body, but shall protrude a minimum of 3/64 inch beyond the inner edge of the body; it shall not be possible by hand to slide the tongue out of

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the cutout in the center bar of the class 4 body (type II only) or over the ribs in the center bar of the class 2 and class 3 body; and the total lateral movement of the tongue tip shall not exceed 5/8 inch. The tongue for the class 4, type II buckle shall be gold plated. The tongue for the class 2 buckle shall be nickel-plated, followed by a lacquer coating. The tongue for the class 3 buckle shall be coated with a clear, baked-on epoxy lacquer.

3.1.4 Finish. The finished buckles shall match chip no. 6 of the institute of heraldry metal finish chip set. The top surfaces, outside edges and back of the buckle body shall be polished to a uniform, mirror like finish. The tongue for class 4, type II shall be gold plated and match the buckle. When tested as specified in 5.4.2 visible chemical reaction such as evolution of gases shall appear.

3.2 Label/marking. All buckles shall be marked for identification with the manufacturer's name or trademark. The marking shall be permanently affixed by stamping, etching, or casting on the back of the buckle and shall be legible.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

5.1 Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this commercial item description; conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices; and is the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

5.2 Market acceptability criteria. The item offered, or a generic equivalent, must have been sold to the commercial market or to the Government for at least two years.

5.3 Warranty. The item offered shall include the standard warranty given to the commercial market beginning with the date of delivery of the individual items.

5.4 Visual examination. Each buckle shall be examined for the defects listed below.

5.4.1 Defects. Not finished or type of finish not as specified; noticeable discoloration, corrosion, or stain; foreign matter embedded in finish of surfaces which are exposed to view when in use; surfaces exposed to view are abraded, scuffed, scratched, or not smooth; lacquered coating (where applicable) blushed, cloudy or not clear, not adherent, blistered, flaking or peeling, not continuous or level; coating not level, uniform, and continuous, e.g., runs, orange peel, wrinkles, drops, or streaks; plating (where applicable) is broken, cut through, corroded, or erupted; class 2 not chrome plated or plating has frosty area on surfaces exposed to view; distorted, bent, malformed, cracked, drag or step in construction and workmanship; digs, gauges, burrs, nicks; tongue fractured, malformed, bent or damaged, binds on center bar; tongue loop loose or open to an extent such that the tongue can be dislodged manually from its position on the center bar; marking missing, illegible, or not as specified; any items not packaged in accordance with the contract or purchase order.

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5.4.2 Acid test for gold plating. The test shall be applied as follows: place a drop of acid not less than 1/16 inch in diameter on three different on three sports on the front face of the buckle allowing the drops to remain for not less than one(1) minute during which time the surface of the buckle shall be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.1.1.1. a minimum of two spots must withstand the acid test. the test shall be applied at room temperature(60 to 80 degrees fahrenheit) and shall consist of a solution containing 50 percent by volume of chemically pure nitric acid (specified gravity 1.42) and an equal volume of distilled water.

6. PACKAGING

6.1 Preservation, packing, and marking. The preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. NOTES

7.1 Sources of documents.

7.1.1 Copies of government documents are available online at https://assist.dla.mil.

7.1.2 Copies of documents are available online at www.astm.org or from the ASTM INTERNATIONAL, 100 Barr Harbor Drive, West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959.

7.1.4 Federal Acquisition Regulations are available online at http://acquisition.gov/far/index.html or by contacting the Superintendent of Documents at 202-512-1800.

7.3 Acceptance criteria. Acceptance criteria shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians
Army - GL
Navy-MC

Review activities
Army - MD

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:
GSA - FSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:
DLA - CT
Project 8315-2021-001

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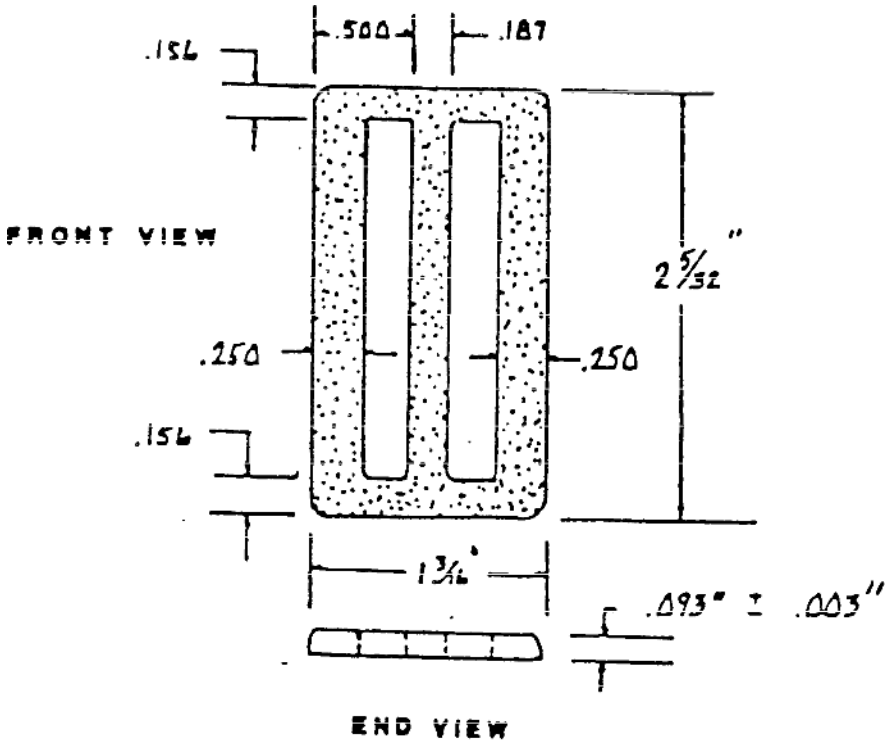


FIGURE I
BUCKLES, BRASS (Class 4, Type I)

TOLERANCES:

FRACTIONS ± 1/64

DECIMALS ± .005”

NOTE: ALL CORNERS AND EDGES SHALL BE SLIGHTLY BEVELED

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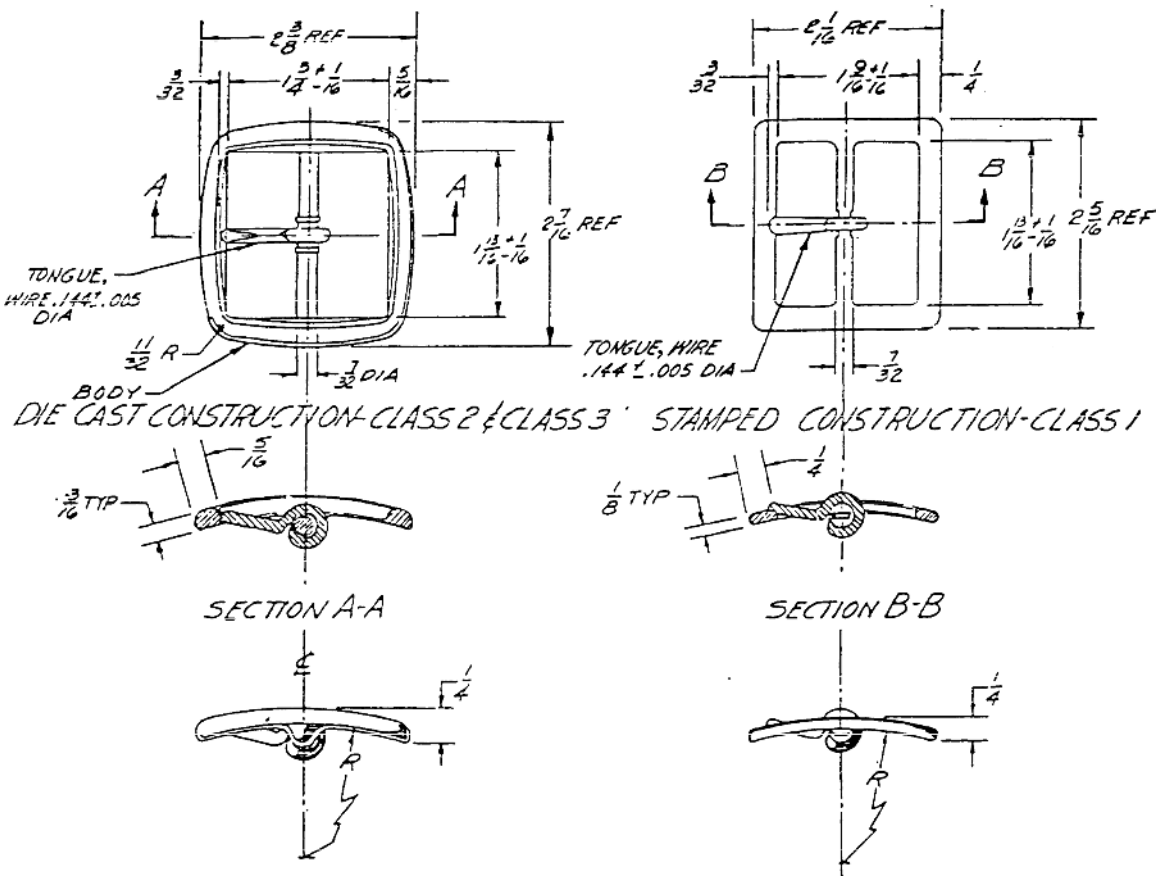


FIGURE II
BUCKLES: Class 4 (Type II), Class 2 & Class 3

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